

54 Ashburner St, Higgins ACT 2615

4 bed · 2 bath · sleeps 8 | Value \$1.0M | Data: AirROI API, 8 Aug 2026 | All figures AUD

● **VERDICT — A CLOSE CALL THAT HINGES ON HOW YOU RUN IT**

Short-term letting is roughly line-ball with a \$750/week long-term rental — a clear win only if you self-manage and execute in the top quartile.

AirROI's median projection nets **\$27,004** vs **\$28,575** long-term (managed). Self-managing adds **+\$11,166/yr**, tipping it decisively ahead. Capital growth — the main wealth driver — is identical either way, so this is a cash-income and effort decision, not a wealth-strategy one.

BASE STR NET INCOME \$27,004 managed · 2.7% net yield	LONG-TERM RENT INCOME \$28,575 \$750/wk · 2.9% net yield	SELF-MANAGING ADDS +\$11,166 per year (drops 18% fee)	BREAK-EVEN OCCUPANCY 50.8% to match long-term rent
---	--	---	--

Scenario returns (AirROI, this property)

SCENARIO	OCC	ADR	GROSS	NET INCOME	VS LTR
Conservative (p25)	36%	\$251	\$38,005	\$9,224	\$-19,351
Base / median	52%	\$346	\$62,033	\$27,004	\$-1,571
Aggressive (p75)	67%	\$456	\$86,899	\$45,405	+\$16,830

Anchored to AirROI revenue percentiles for this 4-bed home. Well-run local 4-beds achieve 58–71% occupancy at \$340–425/night; weak ones under 30%. Execution, not location, drives the outcome.

Leverage & total return

BASE STR	ALL-CASH	80% LVR
After-tax cash	\$18,812	\$-11,444
Cash-on-cash	1.83%	-4.98%
Total return	5.22%	10.24%

Leverage turns cash flow negative (negative gearing — deductible) but lifts total return by amplifying growth. STR & LTR total returns stay within ~1pt.

Key risks

- **ACT levy** → 7.5% from 1 Jul 2027 (from 5%).
- **Performance dispersion** is huge — median-to-upside gap is management quality.
- **Low absolute yield** (~3% net) on a \$1M asset; growth-driven market.
- **Operating intensity** — turnover, cleaning, reviews vs a hands-off tenant.

10-year wealth (all-cash, after-tax)

STRATEGY	CUMULATIVE CASH	TOTAL WEALTH	VS LTR
STR self-managed	\$280,425	\$1,661,024	+\$42,801
STR managed	\$202,342	\$1,582,941	\$-35,282
Long-term rent	\$207,624	\$1,618,223	—

Incl. ~3%/yr income & cost growth, 3.5% capital growth, levy → 7.5% in 2027. The \$410,599 capital gain is common to all three.

Recommendation. If you want passive income, the long-term tenant wins on effort-adjusted return. Pursue short-term only if you'll **self-manage** (or accept ~break-even under a manager) and are comfortable with the operating work and the 2027 levy step-up — in which case it earns roughly **\$9-11k/yr more** and builds **~\$42,801** more wealth over 10 years. Either way, the bulk of your return is the property appreciating, which is identical for both.

Indicative decision aid, not financial or tax advice. Tax figures assume a ~39% marginal rate and are fact-specific — confirm with a registered tax agent. Source: AirROI Airbnb Data API (8 Aug 2026) + labelled market assumptions. Full report and editable model available separately.